

Here is a clear and well-structured note you can use:

Meaning in Context / Reading for Contextual Meaning

Definition

Meaning in context refers to understanding the meaning of a word, phrase, or sentence based on how it is used within a passage, rather than relying only on a dictionary definition.

When we read for contextual meaning, we use clues from the surrounding words, sentences, or paragraph to figure out what a word or expression means.

Why It Is Important

Helps improve reading comprehension

Enables understanding of unfamiliar words

Reduces over-dependence on dictionaries

Makes reading faster and more effective

Context Clues (Types)

Writers often give hints to help readers understand meanings. These hints are called context clues.

Definition Clues

The meaning is directly explained in the sentence.

Example:

A habitat, the natural home of an animal, is important for survival.

Synonym Clues

A word with similar meaning is used.

Example:

The boy was joyful, that is, very happy.

Antonym Clues

A word with opposite meaning is used.

Example:

Unlike his generous brother, he was very stingy.

Example Clues

Examples are given to explain the meaning.

Example:

There are many fruits, such as apples, oranges, and bananas.

Inference Clues

The meaning is not directly stated; the reader must think and infer.

Example:

She wore a thick coat and gloves; it was freezing outside.

(Freezing means very cold)

Steps to Understand Meaning in Context

Read the whole sentence carefully

Look at the words before and after the unfamiliar word

Identify any context clues

Think about the general idea of the passage

Guess the meaning

Check if your guessed meaning makes sense

Example

Sentence:

The man was exhausted after working all day in the sun.

Context Clue: "after working all day"

Meaning: Very tired

Conclusion

Understanding meaning in context is an essential reading skill. It helps readers become independent, confident, and better at understanding texts without always using a dictionary..